

Remuera Renovation - Automation / Electrical

Architect + electrician meeting | decisions to lock before first fix

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Say this at the start:

I want a premium wired smart home. I do not need every automation chosen today, but first-fix wiring must not prevent Dynalite/DALI, motorised blinds, strong networking, security, AV, solar/battery or future integration.

1. Lighting control - decide the architecture now

- ☐ Get a Dynalite / lighting-control integrator to review the plans before conventional switch wiring is finalised.
- ☐ Decide which areas justify Dynalite + DALI: kitchen/living/dining, entry, master suite, basement/golf, feature exterior lighting.
- ☐ Create independent lighting groups now; scenes can combine them later. Avoid permanently wiring together lights we may want separate.
- ☐ Agree keypad locations and scene names before filling walls with conventional switches: Cooking, Dinner, Entertain, Evening, Golf, Movie, Goodnight, Away.
- ☐ Confirm driver strategy for each fitting: DALI, phase dimming, relay or constant-voltage LED. Drivers must be compatible, flicker-free and accessible for replacement.

2. Cabinets / switchboards

- ☐ Agree locations for electrical and Dynalite control cabinets; allow good access, ventilation and sensible cable runs.
- ☐ Allow around 20-30% spare DIN / cabinet capacity and spare control channels.
- ☐ Keep lighting-control hardware out of inaccessible roof spaces or cramped cupboards.

3. Network backbone

- ☐ Use Cat6A and wired Ethernet as the backbone; ceiling-mounted wired access points rather than relying on mesh.
- ☐ Cat6A to TVs, office desks, cameras, doorbell/intercom, garage, gate, solar/battery, EV charger, golf simulator, projector/AV rack and possible wall panels.
- ☐ Agree the main comms-rack location now: ventilated, accessible, UPS, PoE switching, patch panels and spare rack capacity.

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Pre-wire, future-proofing and ownership questions

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4. Pre-wire while walls are open

- ☐ Run spare conduit now - especially rack to roof, garage, gate, basement, eaves and AV/projector/screen positions. Leave pull strings.
- ☐ Pre-wire motorised blinds/curtains in main living areas, master suite and difficult glazing even if motors are added later.
- ☐ Pre-wire door/window contacts, alarm sensors, PoE cameras, doorbell/intercom and garage/gate position/control.
- ☐ Pre-wire useful presence-sensor locations: halls, stairs, entry, pantry, wardrobes, laundry, bathrooms, garage and basement circulation.

5. Basement golf simulator / theatre

- ☐ Treat this as a dedicated subsystem: projector, launch monitor, simulator PC, AV rack, speakers, four Atmos points, subs, network and HVAC.
- ☐ Install large conduit between AV rack, projector and screen wall so future HDMI/fibre can be replaced.
- ☐ Separate lighting for hitting area, seating, bar, steps and cleaning; design Golf, Movie, Bar and Off scenes.

6. HVAC, energy and resilience

- ☐ Confirm HVAC has an integration path and still works independently if the automation layer fails.
- ☐ Design solar/battery/EV integration now: energy monitoring, backup circuits, spare switchboard capacity and controllable large loads.
- ☐ Define which circuits stay alive in a power cut: network, fridge/freezer, security, selected lighting/sockets, gate/garage as appropriate.
- ☐ Consider automatic main-water shutoff plus leak sensors at kitchen, laundry, hot-water equipment and other high-risk areas.

7. Handover / long-term ownership

- ☐ Require as-built drawings, network diagram, lighting-channel schedule, Dyalite/DALI addressing, cabinet schedules and device locations.
- ☐ Require copies of programming/project files, configuration backups, admin credentials and equipment model numbers.
- ☐ Ask every automation supplier: 'If your company disappears in 10 years, can another qualified integrator take over without reverse-engineering the house?'

Five decisions to leave the meeting with

1) Dyalite/DALI direction | 2) Cabinet + rack locations | 3) Integrator involved before first fix
| 4) Cat6A/conduit/blind/security pre-wire | 5) One person owns the integrated electrical/automation plan